

STUDENT TOOLKIT | 2026

LAB NOTEBOOK

Your project's official record, one entry at a time.

Print one entry page per work session, or keep the whole packet in a binder



BEST PRACTICES

- Write in your notebook every time you work on your project, even for short sessions.
- Record the date on every entry.
- Write in pen and never erase. Cross out mistakes with a single line so the original stays readable.
- Record everything as it happens: measurements, observations, surprises, and mistakes.
- Write down full source details the moment you find something useful. Tracking citations during research saves hours later.
- Messy and complete beats neat and missing. Judges trust a working record.

WHY IT MATTERS

Judges read lab notebooks to see how you actually worked. A day-by-day record proves the project is yours and shows your thinking as it developed.

ENTRY PAGE

Date: _____

Session goal: _____

WHAT I DID TODAY

DATA AND MEASUREMENTS

OBSERVATIONS AND SURPRISES

NEXT STEP

ENTRY PAGE

Date: _____

Session goal: _____

WHAT I DID TODAY

DATA AND MEASUREMENTS

OBSERVATIONS AND SURPRISES

NEXT STEP
